

Excel Formulae and Functions

Simple formula:

To begin any formula in Excel, you must first click to select the cell where you want the result to appear and then type the = sign. This tells Excel that the entries that follow are part of a formula.

Next, enter the cell reference (this is made up of the column letter and row number – e.g. A1, B3, C5, etc.), followed by the mathematical operator and then the final cell reference or number.

Please see the following examples:

Purpose	Formula
To add the contents of cells B4 and B7	=B4+B7
To multiply the contents of cells C10 and D10	=C10*D10
To subtract the content of cell C2 from the content of cell C12	=C12-C2
To divide the content of cell B3 by the content of cell C7	=B3/C7

Functions:

A function in Excel is a calculation that has already been prepared for you – almost like a predefined formula. Functions can make complex calculations much quicker and easier to perform.

Please see the following for some examples:

Function	Description	Example
Mathematical		
SUM	Adds up rows or columns of numbers.	=SUM(B2:G2)
ROUND	Round off a number into a value you prefer to see e.g. 873.32935540 to 873.32	=ROUND(F10,2)
Statistical		
AVERAGE	Calculates the average value across a range of data.	=AVERAGE(B2:B9)
COUNT	Counts up the number of entries across a range of cells.	=COUNT(B51:B693)
MIN	Calculates the smallest number in a range of data.	=MIN(A1:A7)
MAX	Calculates the largest number in a range of data.	=MAX(B1:B5)
Conditional		
IF	Used to make decisions based on the data.	=IF(A2<10,'Yes','No')
SUMIF	Used to add the contents of cells if they meet a particular criterion.	=SUMIF(A1:A5,">10")